



YOU ARE **30 WEEKS AND 6 DAYS**

64 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

Here the baby is resting on the placenta, seen at the right-hand side of the image, with the umbilical cord just below the baby's chin. The eyes are closed and this image was taken at a time when the baby was at their quietest, during deep sleep.

“Once your baby's production of red blood cells is in full swing, in theory your immune system could begin to harm your baby.”

At 30 weeks, your baby's red blood cell production switches from the liver to the bone marrow. Their blood type will be determined by your blood group and the baby's father's blood group. Small numbers of the baby's blood cells often leak across the placenta; your body may recognize them as foreign and may attack them.

Your blood group is not important because, although antibodies to blood groups A, B, AB, or O attack your baby's cells in your circulation, they are too large to cross the placenta and attack your baby. Therefore differences in ABO blood groups do not matter. However, everyone is also Rhesus positive (85 percent) or negative (15 percent). If you are Rhesus negative (see [Blood type](#)) and the father is Rhesus positive, your baby may also be Rhesus positive.

Rhesus negative women produce antibodies to rhesus positive blood cells; these can cross the placenta. Once they do, large numbers of antibodies can attack your baby's blood cells, leading to anemia. First pregnancies are rarely affected. To prevent future pregnancies from being affected, a rhesus negative mother will be given anti-D during the pregnancy and after delivery, if it is confirmed that the baby is rhesus positive. Anti-D mops up fetal cells in the maternal bloodstream, preventing the mother from developing antibodies that could cross the placenta and destroy the baby's red cells, causing anemia.

A GOOD NIGHT'S SLEEP

Insomnia is a common problem during pregnancy and can lead to fatigue, feelings of stress and anxiety, and irritability. Whether it's brought on by your increased size, back pain, heartburn, getting up to empty your bladder, or something else, insomnia is not fun. Taking a warm bath or having a small snack before bed may help, as can relaxation techniques, such as deep breathing. A calming scent in a potpourri or fragrance on your pillow may aid relaxation. Make sure to exercise during the day. If you still can't sleep, get up and do something relaxing: read a book, watch TV, or listen to calming music until you feel sleepy. And try to make up for lost sleep with daytime naps.